INTERNATIONAL BEAUTY PROFESSIONALS ASSOCIATION, INC. (IBPA)
A California Nonprofit Mutual Benefit Corporation
California Entity No. B20260111134
Federal EIN: 41-4933353
1220 Melody Ln, Suite 110
Roseville, CA 95678
+1 (279) 529-7117
support@ibpassociations.org
https://ibpassociations.org/

RECORDS RETENTION POLICY

International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc.

Edition	Revised edition (supersedes all prior versions)
Effective date	November 11, 2026
Approved by	Board of Directors of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc., Resolution No. 2026-01 dated November 11, 2026

1. Purpose and Authority

This Records Retention Policy (the "Policy") establishes the formal requirements, retention standards, preservation obligations, storage rules, access controls and destruction procedures applicable to the books, records, documents, files, communications and data of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc. (the "Association" or "IBPA").

This Policy is adopted to:

(a) ensure lawful, consistent and responsible record-keeping practices;

(b) support accurate governance, financial administration and operational continuity;

(c) ensure that records are retained for the periods reasonably necessary to meet legal, regulatory, governance, audit, tax and operational requirements;

(d) protect confidential, sensitive, financial, legal and membership-related information from unauthorized disclosure, loss, misuse, destruction or alteration;

(e) ensure that records are destroyed in an orderly, secure and legally appropriate manner when their further retention is no longer required; and

(f) reduce the legal, operational, reputational and compliance risks associated with improper retention or destruction of records.

This Policy must be read together with the Bylaws, the Governance Policy, the Privacy Policy, the Membership Policy, the Conflict of Interest Policy, the Committee Charters and the Association's other governing documents. In the event of a conflict, the Bylaws prevail unless otherwise required by law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to all records created, received, maintained, posted, transmitted, archived or controlled by the Association, regardless of:

(a) physical or electronic form;

(b) storage medium;

(c) storage location;

(d) whether the record was created within the Association or received from an external source; or

(e) whether the record is held directly by the Association or by an authorized third-party service provider.

This Policy applies to all persons acting on behalf of or in the interests of the Association, including, without limitation:

(a) directors;

(b) officers;

(c) committee members;

(d) employees;

(e) contractors and consultants;

(f) volunteers;

(g) reviewers, judges and evaluators;

(h) authorized agents and representatives; and

(i) any other persons or organizations with access to the Association's records.

All such persons must preserve, manage and handle records in accordance with this Policy and any related procedures adopted by the Association.

3. Definitions

3.1 Record

"Record" means any document, file, correspondence, communication, data set, form, database entry, image, report, spreadsheet, financial statement, application, agreement, memorandum, note, draft or other recorded information created, received or maintained in connection with the Association's activities, regardless of physical or electronic form.

3.2 Official Record

"Official Record" means a record that documents or supports the governance, legal, financial, membership, contractual, policy, tax, compliance or operational matters of the Association and that must be retained under this Policy or applicable law.

3.3 Electronic Record

"Electronic Record" means any record in digital form, including email, cloud data, documents on shared drives, databases, scanned documents, files from messaging systems used for business purposes and other electronically stored information.

3.4 Retention Period

"Retention Period" means the minimum period for which a record must be kept before it may be considered for destruction, unless a longer period is required by law, audit, investigation, legal hold, contract, governance decision or operational need.

3.5 Destruction

"Destruction" means the permanent deletion, disposal, shredding, erasure or other irreversible destruction of a record so that the information cannot reasonably be recovered or retrieved.

3.6 Legal Hold

"Legal Hold" means the obligation to preserve records that may be relevant to litigation, potential litigation, an investigation, audit, subpoena, regulatory inquiry, dispute, enforcement action or similar matter, regardless of the expiry of the ordinary retention period.

4. General Record-Keeping Principles

The Association must keep records that are:

(a) accurate;

(b) complete to the extent reasonably necessary;

(c) organized and retrievable;

(d) protected against unauthorized access, misuse, alteration or destruction;

(e) consistent with applicable law and good governance practice; and

(f) proportionate to the nature, sensitivity and significance of the records.

Records should be retained only for the period reasonably necessary for legal, tax, regulatory, governance, contractual, operational, legal or historical purposes. Records must not be destroyed if they are subject to a legal hold or another preservation requirement.

The Association must make reasonable efforts to prevent:

(a) premature destruction of records that must be retained; and

(b) indefinite retention of records that no longer need to be kept.

5. Categories of Records

Without limitation, records covered by this Policy include the following categories:

5.1 Corporate and Governance Records

Including, without limitation:

(a) the Articles of Incorporation;

(b) the Bylaws and all amendments;

(c) resolutions of the Board of Directors;

(d) minutes of Board and committee meetings;

(e) governance policies;

(f) committee charters;

(g) annual governance reports;

(h) internal governance memoranda.

5.2 Membership and Application Records

Including, without limitation:

(a) membership applications;

(b) supporting documents submitted by applicants;

(c) evaluations of applicants;

(d) membership status records;

(e) membership renewals;

(f) disciplinary or review materials;

(g) member directory records;

(h) records relating to appeals.

5.3 Financial and Tax Records

Including, without limitation:

(a) budgets;

(b) bank statements;

(c) ledgers and accounting reports;

(d) invoices and receipts;

(e) payment records;

(f) expense reimbursement records;

(g) tax returns and supporting materials;

(h) audit materials;

(i) records confirming approval of payments.

5.4 Contractual and Legal Records

Including, without limitation:

(a) signed contracts;

(b) contract amendments and addenda;

(c) sponsorship agreements;

(d) vendor agreements;

(e) service agreements;

(f) legal correspondence;

(g) demand letters;

(h) dispute records;

(i) settlement records (if any).

5.5 Program, Event and Award Records

Including, without limitation:

(a) event planning materials;

(b) registration data;

(c) speaker agreements;

(d) competition materials;

(e) judging materials;

(f) award nominations;

(g) award decisions;

(h) program evaluations.

5.6 Communications and Administrative Records

Including, without limitation:

(a) official email correspondence;

(b) administrative correspondence;

(c) notices;

(d) newsletters and public announcements;

(e) policy drafts and their revision history, where applicable;

(f) internal operational documents.

5.7 Intellectual Property and Brand Records

Including, without limitation:

(a) trademark-related materials;

(b) logos and brand materials;

(c) publication rights records;

(d) licenses granted or received;

(e) records confirming rights to website content.

5.8 Personnel and Contractor Records (if any)

Including, without limitation:

(a) contractor agreements;

(b) payment records;

(c) role descriptions;

(d) performance evaluation records;

(e) confidentiality agreements.

6. Retention Periods

The Association must retain records for at least the minimum periods set out below, unless a longer period is required by law, contract, audit, legal hold or decision of the Board of Directors.

6.1 Permanent Retention

The following records are retained permanently:

(a) the Articles of Incorporation;

(b) the Bylaws and all amendments;

(c) minutes of Board and committee meetings of material governance significance;

(d) Board resolutions and key governance decisions;

(e) core policies and their amendments;

(f) tax-exemption determination records (if applicable);

(g) records confirming intellectual property rights;

(h) historical records designated as permanent by the Board of Directors.

6.2 Financial and Tax Records — Minimum 7 (Seven) Years

Unless a longer period is required, the following records are retained for at least seven (7) years:

(a) annual financial statements;

(b) ledgers;

(c) invoices and receipts;

(d) bank statements and reconciliations;

(e) expense reimbursement records;

(f) tax returns and supporting materials;

(g) financial reports and working papers;

(h) payment transaction records, if maintained by the Association.

6.3 Membership and Application Records

Unless otherwise required:

(a) denied or incomplete applications — at least 3 (three) years after the decision;

(b) approved applications and core member records — for the term of membership plus at least 3 (three) years;

(c) application review materials, including minutes of the Membership Review Board — at least 7 (seven) years;

(d) disciplinary, suspension or termination matters — 5 (five) to 7 (seven) years after closure.

6.4 Contracts and Legal Records

(a) contracts — term plus at least 7 (seven) years;

(b) significant contracts — longer where necessary;

(c) legal correspondence — at least 7 (seven) years.

6.5 Event and Award Records

(a) event records — at least 3 years;

(b) nominations and evaluations — 3 to 5 years;

(c) competition materials — at least 3 years;

(d) award records — at least 5 years.

6.6 Board of Directors and Board Candidate Records

(a) minutes and resolutions of the Board of Directors and minutes of the Nominating and Governance Committee — permanently (Section 6.1);

(b) Board Member Agreements, Conflict of Interest Disclosure Statements and Acknowledgments of Governing Documents — for the director's term of office plus at least 7 (seven) years;

(c) questionnaires and evaluation forms of elected candidates — for the term of office plus at least 3 (three) years;

(d) questionnaires and evaluation forms of candidates not elected — at least 3 (three) years after the decision.

6.7 Administrative Records

2–3 years, unless covered by another category.

6.8 Drafts

May be deleted if they have no legal value.

7. Storage, Organization and Protection of Records

The Association must ensure that all records are stored in a secure, organized and controlled manner appropriate to their nature, sensitivity and significance.

Without limiting the foregoing, the Association must implement reasonable administrative, technical and physical safeguards designed to:

(a) prevent unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration or destruction of records;

(b) protect records against accidental loss, damage or corruption;

(c) ensure continuity of access and operational usability;

(d) ensure timely retrieval of records when needed for governance, operational, legal, financial or compliance purposes; and

(e) preserve the integrity, accuracy and completeness of records.

7.1 Electronic Records

Electronic records must be stored using reasonably secure systems, which may include:

(a) password-protected platforms;

(b) role-based access controls;

(c) secure cloud storage;

(d) encrypted systems, where applicable;

(e) backup and recovery systems;

(f) logs, monitoring or audit trails, where applicable.

The Association must take reasonable measures to ensure that electronic records are regularly backed up and protected against system failures, cyber threats or unauthorized access.

7.2 Physical Records

Physical records must be stored in secure locations, including, without limitation:

(a) locked cabinets or storage;

(b) restricted-access premises or facilities;

(c) controlled access to sensitive records;

(d) protection from environmental factors where reasonably possible.

7.3 Access Control

Access to records must be limited to persons with a legitimate business, governance or operational need.

Access may be restricted based on:

(a) role;

(b) level of authority;

(c) the confidentiality level of the record;

(d) legal or compliance requirements.

Unauthorized access to, use or distribution of records is strictly prohibited.

8. Confidentiality and Sensitive Information

The Association recognizes that certain records contain confidential, proprietary, personal, financial, legal or other sensitive information requiring enhanced protection.

Such records must be handled in accordance with:

(a) the Privacy Policy;

(b) the Governance Policy;

(c) the Conflict of Interest Policy;

(d) applicable contractual obligations; and

(e) applicable laws and regulations.

Confidential information:

(a) must not be disclosed to unauthorized persons;

(b) must not be stored or transmitted in unsecured systems;

(c) must be accessible only on a need-to-know basis; and

(d) must be protected against misuse, unauthorized copying or distribution.

Where necessary, the Association may classify records by sensitivity level and set appropriate access restrictions.

9. Responsibility for Records Management

The Board of Directors has ultimate responsibility for overseeing record-keeping practices and compliance with this Policy.

The Board may assign specific roles for administering and implementing this Policy, including, without limitation:

(a) the Secretary, who may oversee corporate records, governance records and official filings;

(b) the Treasurer, who may oversee financial records and accounting documentation;

(c) committee chairs, who may be responsible for maintaining and transferring committee records;

(d) designated administrative staff or service providers responsible for technical storage, archiving and record access systems.

All persons with access to the Association's records must comply with this Policy and applicable procedures.

Non-compliance may result in disciplinary, governance or contractual consequences.

10. Destruction of Records

Records may be destroyed only when all of the following conditions are met:

(a) the applicable retention period has expired;

(b) the record is not subject to a Legal Hold;

(c) the record is not required for any current or reasonably anticipated legal, audit, compliance, governance, financial or operational process; and

(d) destruction is carried out in a secure and appropriate manner.

Destruction methods must be appropriate to the nature of the record and may include:

(a) shredding of paper records;

(b) secure disposal of paper media;

(c) permanent deletion of electronic data;

(d) certified destruction by authorized contractors.

The Association must take reasonable measures to ensure that destroyed records cannot be recovered.

11. Suspension of Destruction; Legal Hold

If the Association becomes aware of, or reasonably anticipates:

(a) litigation or threatened litigation;

(b) an audit or regulatory examination;

(c) an investigation or inquiry;

(d) a subpoena or legal demand;

(e) a dispute or enforcement process; or

(f) an internal disciplinary or governance proceeding,

destruction of the relevant records must be suspended immediately.

Once a Legal Hold is in place:

(a) the persons concerned must be notified;

(b) all relevant records must be preserved in their current state;

(c) standard destruction procedures are suspended;

(d) any alteration or deletion of such records is prohibited.

The Legal Hold remains in effect until it is formally lifted by the Association or an authorized legal or governance body.

12. Prohibited Actions

No person acting on behalf of the Association may:

(a) destroy records in violation of this Policy;

(b) destroy or alter records subject to a Legal Hold;

(c) intentionally misrepresent, alter or falsify records;

(d) conceal or withhold records relating to governance, legal, financial or compliance matters;

(e) remove or transfer records without authorization;

(f) keep official records in personal systems in a manner that prevents the Association's control or access.

Any such action may result in disciplinary measures, removal from office, termination of membership, contractual consequences or legal liability.

13. Periodic Review and Administration of the Policy

The Board of Directors or persons authorized by it may periodically review:

(a) record categories;

(b) retention periods;

(c) storage systems;

(d) compliance practices;

(e) risks associated with records management.

The Association may adopt additional procedures or internal guidelines to implement this Policy.

14. Relationship to Other Governing Documents

This Policy applies together with:

- the Bylaws;
- the Governance Policy;
- the Privacy Policy;
- the Membership Policy;
- the Conflict of Interest Policy;
- the Committee Charters;
- the Membership Application Review Procedure and the Membership Review Policy;
- and the Association's other governing documents.

In the event of a conflict, the Bylaws prevail unless otherwise provided by law.

15. Amendments

This Policy may be amended, supplemented or repealed by the Board of Directors at any duly convened meeting or by other lawful means.

Amendments take effect as provided in the relevant decision unless otherwise stated.

16. Official Language

The official version of this Policy is maintained in English. Any translation is provided for convenience only. In the event of any discrepancy, the English version prevails.